

Project Report

Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

Developed on the ServiceNow Developer Site (Personal Developer Instance)

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

Organisations often keep their data in spreadsheets such as Excel files. Entering this data into an enterprise platform record by record is slow and error-prone. This project demonstrates how spreadsheet data can be imported into ServiceNow using the **Import Set** feature together with a **Transform Map**.

The spreadsheet is attached to a Data Source and loaded into a temporary staging table called the Import Set table. A Transform Map then maps each source column to a field in the target table, and running the transform moves the data into the target table. The work was carried out on a Personal Developer Instance (PDI) from the ServiceNow Developer site.

1.2 Purpose

- To understand the Import Set and Transform Map concepts in ServiceNow.
- To import bulk data from an Excel spreadsheet into a ServiceNow table without manual entry.
- To map spreadsheet columns to target table fields correctly and verify the imported records.
- To save time and reduce data-entry mistakes during data migration.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

Data stored in spreadsheets has to be moved into ServiceNow tables. Adding hundreds of rows manually takes a lot of time, leads to typing errors and inconsistent data. A reliable and repeatable method is needed to load spreadsheet data into ServiceNow with correct field mapping.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

Says	Thinks
"Entering this data one by one takes too long." "Can we just upload the Excel file?"	Will the data go into the correct fields? Will duplicate or wrong records be created?
Does	Feels
Maintains data in Excel sheets, copies values manually, rechecks records for mistakes.	Frustrated by repetitive work, worried about errors, relieved when the import is automatic.

2.3 Brainstorming

- Option 1: Manual entry of every record (slow, error-prone).
- Option 2: Copy and paste into the list view (limited and not repeatable).
- Option 3: Import the spreadsheet using Import Sets and a Transform Map (fast, repeatable, field-level control). **Selected.**

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey Map

Stage	Activity	Outcome
Prepare	User prepares the data in an Excel (.xlsx) file	Clean spreadsheet with column headers
Upload	User creates a Data Source and attaches the file	File available to ServiceNow

Stage	Activity	Outcome
Load	User runs Load All Records	Data stored in the Import Set table
Map	User creates a Transform Map and field maps	Columns linked to target fields
Transform	User runs the transform	Records inserted / updated in target table
Verify	User opens the target table list	Imported data confirmed

3.2 Solution Requirement

Functional requirements

- Create a Data Source of type File and format Excel.
- Load spreadsheet rows into an Import Set table.
- Create a Transform Map from the Import Set table to the target table.
- Map source columns to target fields and run the transform.
- View inserted / updated / ignored / skipped counts.

Non-functional requirements

- Accuracy: imported values must match the spreadsheet.
- Usability: steps should be simple and repeatable.
- Performance: bulk data should load in a reasonable time.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram



Data moves from the spreadsheet to the Data Source, is loaded into the Import Set table, is converted by the Transform Map, and finally lands in the target table.

3.4 Technology Stack

Component	Technology
Platform	ServiceNow (Personal Developer Instance)
Source data	Microsoft Excel spreadsheet (.xlsx)
Features used	Data Source, Import Set, Transform Map, Field Maps
Access	Web browser via ServiceNow Developer site

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The problem is slow and error-prone manual data entry from spreadsheets. ServiceNow already provides Import Sets and Transform Maps, which directly solve this by automating bulk loading with controlled field mapping. The solution fits the need because it is built into the platform and needs no extra tools.

4.2 Proposed Solution

- Create a Data Source and attach the Excel file.

- Load the data into an Import Set table.
- Create a Transform Map and map each source column to a target field.
- Run the transform and verify the records in the target table.

4.3 Solution Architecture

The architecture has three layers: (1) the **source layer**, containing the Excel file and Data Source; (2) the **staging layer**, the Import Set table that holds the raw rows; and (3) the **transformation layer**, where the Transform Map applies field mappings and writes to the target table.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

5.1 Project Planning

Task	Description	Duration / Date
1	Study Import Set and Transform Map concepts	
2	Set up the ServiceNow Developer instance	
3	Prepare the Excel spreadsheet	
4	Create Data Source and load data	
5	Create Transform Map and field maps	
6	Run transform, test and verify results	
7	Prepare documentation and report	

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

S.No.	Parameter	Values
1.	Data Source	Type: File, Format: Excel (.xlsx), Retrieval: Attachment
2.	Import Set table	Name: _____ Rows loaded: _____
3.	Transform Map	Name: _____ Target table: _____
4.	Transform result	Inserted: ____ Updated: ____ Ignored: ____ Skipped: ____ Errors: ____
5.	Verification	Imported records checked in the target table list view

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

[Screenshot: Data Source created]

[Screenshot: Import Set table with loaded data]

[Screenshot: Transform Map and field maps]

[Screenshot: Transform result / history]

[Screenshot: Records in target table]

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages

- Saves time by loading many records at once.
- Reduces manual data-entry errors.
- Field-level control through field maps.
- Repeatable for future imports.

- Built into the ServiceNow platform.

Disadvantages

- Column names in the sheet must match or be mapped carefully.
- Poor quality data in the spreadsheet leads to wrong records.
- Wrong mapping or coalesce settings can create duplicates or overwrite data.
- Needs basic knowledge of ServiceNow tables and fields.

9. CONCLUSION

The project showed how spreadsheet data can be imported into ServiceNow using a Data Source, an Import Set table and a Transform Map. This method is quicker and more accurate than manual entry and can be reused whenever new data needs to be loaded.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

- Use coalesce fields to update existing records and avoid duplicates.
- Add transform scripts or field-level scripts for data cleaning.
- Schedule imports automatically using Scheduled Imports.
- Import from other sources such as CSV, JDBC or REST APIs.

11. APPENDIX

Source Code (if any)	Not applicable (configuration-based project)
Dataset Link	_____
GitHub & Project Demo Link	_____